

The History Department

YEAR 7 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of The History Portal pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized PEE/PEEL Structure Strips, Causal Connective Banks, consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time

Year 7 | Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?

🌀 SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

PUBLIC HEALTH & STATE POWER

Roman civic governance → Medieval municipal neglect → 1848 Public Health Act (L1, L2, L4)

SANITARY ENGINEERING & TECH

Roman aqueducts → Lead piping → Bazalgette's brick sewer network (L1, L6)

ETIOLOGY & SCIENTIFIC EMPIRICISM

Divine retribution & Miasma → John Snow's Broad St map → Germ Theory (L3, L5)

WORKING-CLASS ACTIVISM & RIGHTS

Polluted town riots → Water rate strikes → Public demand for health infrastructure (L2, L4)

Lesson Number & Title

Learning Objectives & Enquiry

Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment

Lesson 1

How much progress did the Romans make in public health?

CHANGE & CONTINUITY

- Describe the key features of Roman public health infrastructure, including aqueducts, bathhouses, and sewers
- Explain how the Roman Empire's centralised power enabled large-scale public health projects
- Evaluate the significance of Roman public health by assessing whether it represented genuine medical understanding or imperial prestige

📄 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS:

Housesteads Fort Roman communal latrines (Hadrian's Wall); Seneca's moral treatise on Roman baths; Fishbourne Roman Palace mosaics

🗨️ DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS:

Roman engineering triumphalism vs lived public health reality: lead piping & parasite transmission

📝 CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT:

[Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 2 Why did public health decline during the Middle Ages? HISTORICAL EVIDENCE & MONASTIC LIFE	- Describe the sanitation challenges faced by rapidly expanding medieval towns between 1250 and 1500 - Explain the municipal regulations introduced by town corporations, including gong farmers and rakers - Evaluate the impact of the Black Death (1348) and the significance of the 1388 Statute of Cambridge	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Canterbury Cathedral Waterworks Plan (c. 1165); City of London Sanitary Ordinance of 1357; Monastic reredorter latrine architecture DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Medieval hygiene myths: Religious purity and monastic engineering vs urban municipal paralysis CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 3 To what extent did towns become filthier during the Early Modern period? CAUSATION & ETIOLOGICAL BELIEFS	- Explain how the explosive growth of early modern London overwhelmed existing waste systems - Analyse the significance of Sir John Harington's flushing water closet (1596) and why it failed to catch on - Evaluate eyewitness evidence from Samuel Pepys and the impact of the Great Plague of 1665	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Sir John Harington's 1596 'Ajax' Toilet Diagram; Samuel Pepys' 1660 Diary on cellar privies; The Cowdray Engraving of Tudor Portsmouth (1545) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Laissez-faire policy debate & Roy Porter on early modern infrastructure limits; technological innovation vs municipal failure CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 4 How did the Industrial Revolution lead to a public health crisis? HISTORICAL SIGNIFICANCE & STATE INTERVENTION	- Describe the squalid living conditions of rapidly industrialising cities like Manchester and Leeds - Explain how the arrival of Asiatic Cholera in 1831 exposed the failure of British sanitation - Evaluate Edwin Chadwick's 1842 Report and the reasons for resistance to public health reform	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Chadwick's 1842 Report on the Sanitary Condition of the Labouring Population; Dr John Snow's Broad Street Cholera Spot Map (1854); Portsmouth cholera burial registers DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Industrial urbanisation: Miasma theory vs early contagionist epidemiology; laissez-faire vs state health intervention CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 5 Why did it take the "Great Stink" to finally clean up Britain's streets? SOURCE UTILITY & EPIDEMIOLOGICAL MAPPING	- Explain how the Thames became an open, tidal sewer due to middle-class flush toilets - Describe the events of the "Great Stink" in June 1858 and the panic it caused in Parliament - Evaluate the engineering achievements of Joseph Bazalgette and the motives behind the 1858 legislation	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Punch Cartoon 'The Silent Highwayman' (1858 Great Stink); Bazalgette's Victorian intercepting sewer blueprints (1859–1865); Source A: Punch Cartoon: "Father Thames Introducing His Offspring to London" (1858) DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: The Great Stink of 1858: Parliamentary self-interest and physical stench vs municipal laissez-faire ideology CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 6 Why did it take the scientific revolution of Germ Theory to finally conquer water-borne disease? TURNING POINT ANALYSIS & CIVIL ENGINEERING	- Analyse Dr. John Snow's epidemiological investigation of the 1854 Broad Street cholera outbreak - Examine Snow's 1854 Cholera Spot Map and explain how he proved water contamination - Evaluate why the medical establishment rejected Snow's theory and how Germ Theory (1861) and Koch (1883) verified it	PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Dr John Snow's 1854 Broad Street Cholera Spot Map; Soho mortality records & Eley Brothers percussion cap factory logs; Source A: Dr. John Snow's Original 1854 Cholera Spot Map of Soho, London DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Snow's empirical epidemiological mapping vs the entrenched medical establishment and Board of Health CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.

KS3: Medieval England & The Struggle for Power (1066–1485)

Year 7 | How did power shift in Medieval England?

SPIRAL CURRICULUM THEMATIC STRANDS (VERTICAL DISCIPLINARY PROGRESSION) CHRISTINE COUNSELL CURRICULAR THREADS

MONARCHY, LAW & STATE POWER

Norman conquest autocracy → Royal justice & Clarendon → Magna Carta & Dynastic collapse (L1–L4, L8)

FEUDAL ECONOMY & MILITARY TECH

Motte-and-bailey engineering → Domesday land audit → Post-plague market economy (L1, L2, L5, L6)

CATHOLIC HEGEMONY & IDEOLOGY

Papal supremacy & Becket martyrdom → Doom paintings & tithes → Divine plague etiology (L3, L5, L6)

POPULAR & BARONIAL RESISTANCE

Saxon rebellions & Hereward → Runnymede baronial revolt → 1381 Peasants' March on London (L2, L4, L7)

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 1 Lesson 1: 1066 - Why did three men claim one throne, and how did William win?  CAUSATION (1066 SUCCESSION CRISIS)	- Describe the three rival claims to the English throne in 1066 and assess which was strongest - Explain how the Battle of Hastings demonstrated the role of power, luck, and military strategy in shaping history - Evaluate the significance of the Norman Conquest as a turning point in English history	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle for the year 1066; Source B: The Bayeux Tapestry; Source C: The Battle of Hastings (19th Century)  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Explain why there was a succession crisis in 1066 and evaluate the claims of the three rivals.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 1: The Claimants' Pitch (Group Battle) Imagine you are an adviser to the Witan (the council of English lords) in January 1066. Write a short persuasive speech (3–4 sen...
Lesson 2 Lesson 2: Castles, Terror, and the Domesday Book - How did William control England?  HISTORICAL EVIDENCE (BAYEUX TAPESTRY)	- Explain how William used castles, the feudal system, and terror as tools of power and control - Describe how the Domesday Book functioned as a mechanism of royal authority and resistance suppression - Assess the effectiveness of William's methods in crushing Anglo-Saxon resistance	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source C: An extract from the Ecclesiastical History by the Anglo-Norman monk and chronicler Orderic Vitalis.; Source D: An extract from the Anglo-Saxon Chronicle, written by contemporary English monks.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the causes and devastating consequences of the Harrying of the North.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain why William carried out the Harrying of the North and what the consequences were for the people living in the region.
Lesson 3 Lesson 3: Crown vs Church: Why did Henry II clash with Thomas Becket?  SIGNIFICANCE & STATE CONTROL (DOMESDAY BOOK)	- Explain why the relationship between the monarchy and the Church was a fundamental struggle for power in medieval England - Describe how the murder of Thomas Becket (1170) demonstrated the tension between feudal loyalty and religious authority - Evaluate the significance of the Becket affair for the balance of power between Church and Crown	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from a letter sent by Thomas Becket in French exile to King Henry II, c. 1166; Extract from the chronicle of Edward Grim, c. 1174–1177  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Evaluate the reasons for the complete breakdown in relations between Henry and Becket.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain the main reasons why the relationship between King Henry II and Archbishop Thomas Becket broke down completely between 1162 and 1164.
Lesson 4 Lesson 4: Magna Carta (1215): A triumph of liberty or a selfish baronial power grab?  CHANGE & CONTINUITY (FEUDAL STRUCTURE)	- Describe the key grievances that led the barons to challenge King John's power - Explain the significance of Magna Carta as a challenge to absolute monarchy and a step towards parliamentary democracy - Evaluate contrasting historical interpretations of Magna Carta: triumph of liberty or selfish baronial power grab?	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from Clause 39 of the Magna Carta, June 1215; Adapted from modern historical scholarship on the 1215 settlement  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Historical Interpretations: The Magna Carta  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 3: The Trial of King John (Interpretation) Divide your answer into two parts: 1. You are King John's defense lawyer. Write a short paragraph defending his actions, exp...

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives & Enquiry	Curriculum Rigour: Evidence, Debate & Assessment
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Doom Paintings and Tithes: What was life like in a medieval village?  INTERPRETATIONS & CONSTITUTIONAL LAW (MAGNA CARTA)	- Describe the key features of daily life for the peasantry in a medieval village - Explain how the feudal system and the Church controlled virtually every aspect of a peasant's existence - Assess the extent to which medieval peasants had any real power or agency within the feudal hierarchy	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: A depiction of a busy medieval parish church.; Source B: A medieval record detailing the collection of church tithes from peasant families.; Source C: The famous medieval Doom Painting at Chaldon Church, Surrey, dating from around 1200.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Describe what a tithe was, how it was collected, and why it caused tension between ordinary medieval peasants and the Church.
Lesson 6 Lesson 6: 1348: How did the Black Death shatter medieval social order?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE (THE BLACK DEATH)	- Describe the causes and spread of the Black Death across medieval England - Explain how the plague shattered the feudal system by empowering the peasantry through labour shortages - Evaluate the significance of the Black Death as a catalyst for change in medieval social order	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from the Statute of Labourers, 1351  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: Explain how the Black Death transformed the balance of economic power between lords and peasants after 1348.
Lesson 7 Lesson 7: 1381: Why did the Peasants revolt, and did they achieve anything?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Explain the causes of the Peasants' Revolt, linking them to the decline of feudalism and growing resistance to royal power - Describe the key events of the revolt and the role of leaders like Wat Tyler - Evaluate whether the Peasants' Revolt was a failure or a significant step towards challenging the power of the monarchy and Parliament	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Extract from a sermon by John Ball, recorded in Jean Froissart's Chronicles  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Analyze the extent of the threat posed by the rebels when they captured London.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 2: How much of a threat did the rebels actually pose to King Richard II and royal government when they seized London in June 1381?
Lesson 8 Lesson 8: The Wars of the Roses (1455–1485) – How did the medieval era end in blood?  CAUSATION & CONSEQUENCE	- Describe the causes of the Wars of the Roses and how rival claims to the monarchy led to civil war - Explain how propaganda and political manipulation shaped the conflict between York and Lancaster - Evaluate the significance of Henry VII's victory at Bosworth as the end of the medieval era and the birth of Tudor power	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Source A: An extract from the contemporary account 'How Richard III Made Himself King' by the Italian traveler Dominic Mancini, written in the summer of 1483.; Source B: A portrait of King Richard III, painted by an unknown artist in the sixteenth century.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: Core Disciplinary Concept: Historical Enquiry & Causal Argumentation  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Synthesis] Complete structured analytical enquiry response in pupil workbook.
Lesson 9 Lesson 9: Assessment: How powerful was a medieval monarch?  HISTORICAL ENQUIRY & ANALYSIS	- Synthesise knowledge of power, monarchy, feudalism, and the Church across the medieval period - Construct a sustained argument evaluating how far a medieval monarch's power was limited by resistance from barons, the Church, and the peasantry - Deploy specific historical evidence to support a judgement about the nature of medieval power	 PRIMARY EVIDENCE & SOURCE ANALYSIS: Interpretation A: A modern historian writing about the early Norman period.; Interpretation B: A modern historian writing about the Later Middle Ages.  DISCIPLINARY DEBATE / HISTORIAN FOCUS: To evaluate differing historical interpretations of medieval royal power.  CORE WRITTEN ASSESSMENT: [Written Task] Task 1: Which of the two interpretations do you find more convincing? Explain your answer using your own knowledge.

Unit Key Vocabulary: Power • Claim • Conquest • Anglo-Saxon • Significance • Feudal system • Resistance • Propaganda • Domesday Book • Motte-and-bailey • Church • Monarchy • Martyr • Excommunication • Canon law • Magna Carta • Democracy • Parliament • Interpretation • Baron •

